prosthetic leg. Six years after that flight, as promised, he was running a marathon. Not the London marathon, which would've been miraculous on its own. He was running *his own marathon*, along a route he'd designed himself, in the outline of a poppy laid over the city of London.

A staggering thirty-one miles, he'd done the full circuit to raise money and awareness—and heart rates.

I'm in shock, he said on finding me there.

You're in shock? I said. *That makes two of us.*

Seeing him out there, still being a soldier, despite no longer being a soldier—that was the answer to the riddle with which I'd been struggling so long.

Question: How do you stop being a soldier, when a soldier is all you've ever been or wanted to be?

Answer: You don't.

Even when you stop being a soldier, you don't have to stop being a soldier. Ever.

78.

An Afghanistan war service at St. Paul's Cathedral, and then a reception at the Guildhall hosted by the City of London Corporation, and then the launch of Walking With The Wounded's Walk Of Britain, and then a visit to England's rugby team, and then watching them practice for a match against France, and then following them to Twickenham and cheering them on, and then a memorial for the Olympian Richard Meade, the most successful equestrian in British history, and then a trip with Pa to Turkey to attend ceremonies marking the hundredth anniversary of Gallipoli, and then a meeting with descendants of the men who fought in that epic battle, and then back to London to hand out medals to runners at the London Marathon.